

A PORTFOLIO WEBSITE FOR MODELS

The Free Model Stack

An emrata-style portfolio with fullscreen slideshows and a drag-and-drop content system — engineered to serve your photos in true 4K to roughly 1.6 million visitors a month, for zero dollars. This document explains, in plain language, how every piece works and how to run it.

\$0

PER MONTH, ALWAYS

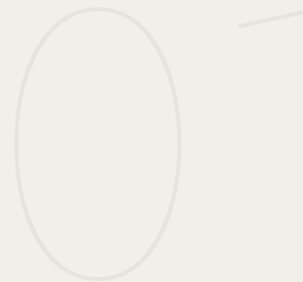
4K

PHOTO QUALITY

~1.6M

VISITORS / MONTH

A site that behaves like the ones you already admire.



Nothing templated-looking. One uninterrupted photograph at a time, your name set in quiet type, and nothing else competing for attention.

01 A fullscreen home slideshow

Your strongest images, one at a time — a new photograph every few seconds, click the left or right edge to move through.

02 Up to twenty project galleries

Campaigns, editorials, tests — each its own left-to-right carousel, titled however you like.

03 About & contact pages

Your story, measurements, representation — with a contact page that routes enquiries to your agencies by region.

04 A private admin you actually enjoy

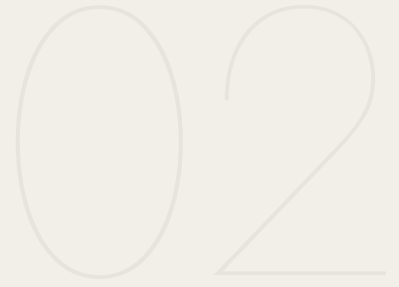
Drag, drop, reorder, done. No developer needed to run it day to day. Changes are live within a minute.

05 Your own domain

yourname.com — plus a private admin.yourname.com for you. Included in the setup.

THE DESIGN

Ivory paper, ink type, hairline rules — a Futura-style face (Jost) with wide letterspacing, set like a printed lookbook. Swap the font or palette in two lines of code when your book evolves.



Free stops working only if you step on two specific rakes.

Hosting a photo-heavy site costs money on most platforms because they meter the two heaviest things — image processing and bandwidth. This stack is arranged so that neither one is ever metered.

TRAP ONE · THE OPTIMIZER CAP

If a site builder “optimizes” your photos for you, the free plan typically includes about **1,000 images a month**. Your homepage slideshow alone could be twenty. Thirteen visitors and you’re done.

This stack does the opposite: your photos are prepared once, beautifully, before they’re ever uploaded — so no optimizer ever touches them. There is nothing to count.

TRAP TWO · THE BANDWIDTH CAP

Free front-ends usually meter data — around **100 GB a month**. If your photos travelled through that front-end, a hundred high-quality images (≈ 300 MB per gallery pass) would exhaust it after roughly **350 visitors**.

Here the photos never pass through it. They’re delivered by Cloudflare’s global network directly, where egress costs nothing.

WHAT THE FREE PLANS ALLOW, AND WHAT THIS SITE USES

VERCEL · SITE CODE

100 GB/mo — one visitor downloads ≈ 65 KB $\rightarrow$ about 1.6M visitors

VERCEL · PROCESSING

125k operations — visitors use ~ 0 ; only your admin logins

CLOUDFLARE R2 · STORAGE

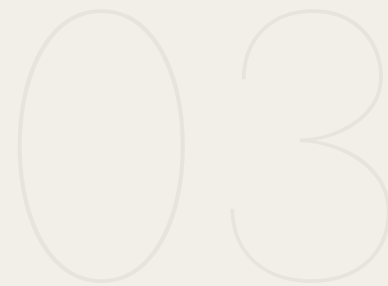
10 GB free — 100 photos ≈ 0.3 GB

CLOUDFLARE R2 · DELIVERY

egress is always free; edge cache absorbs repeat views

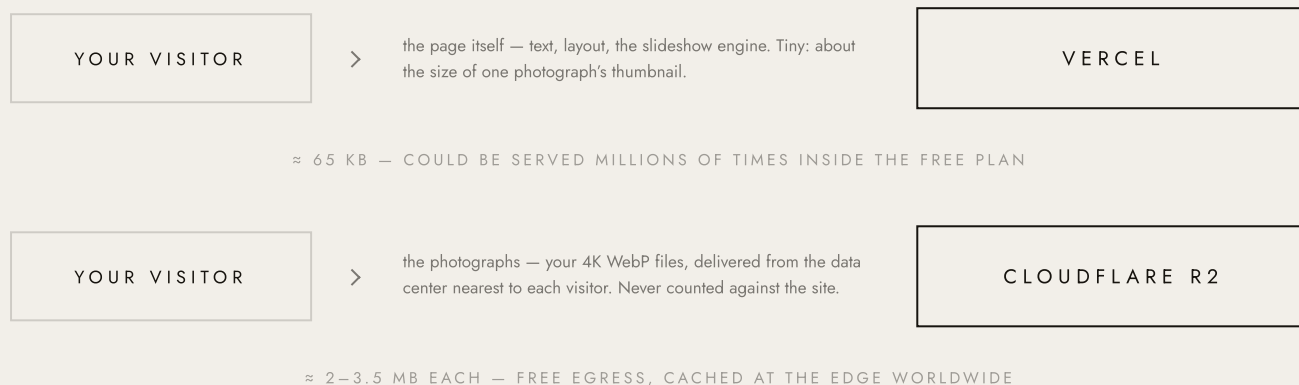
THE ONE SENTENCE VERSION

Your code comes from Vercel; your photographs come from Cloudflare. Each platform meters only the thing that’s tiny, and gives away the thing that’s heavy.



Two specialists, one seamless site.

When someone opens your site, their browser quietly asks two different companies for two different kinds of thing — and stitches them into one experience.



THREE QUIET IDEAS UNDERNEATH

01

The manifest

One small file in the cloud is the single source of truth: which photos belong to which slideshow. Your admin rewrites it; the website reads it. No database, no rebuild, no waiting on a developer.

02

Prepared photos

Before upload, every photo is resized to a maximum of 3840 pixels (true 4K) and encoded as WebP at high quality — about 1.5–3.5 MB instead of 35 MB, indistinguishable on screen. The heavy original never travels.

03

A locked door

The admin sits behind a password of your choosing (stored as an irreversible fingerprint, never as text). Sessions expire; brute-force attempts are throttled. Only you rearrange your book.

The admin: your book, on your schedule.

Everything on the site is movable with a drag. Open `admin.yourname.com` on any device — there is no app to install and nothing to learn beyond dragging.

01 Sign in

One password. Your session remembers you for a week on each device.

02 Choose a shelf

A sidebar lists Home Slideshow, About Photo, and every project — up to twenty. Pick one.

03 Drop photos — one or twenty at once

Drag files straight from your desktop, or click to browse. Multiple files queue automatically, with progress for each.

04 Arrange by dragging

Drag any photo onto another slot to reorder. Drop on the dashed box to send it to the end. Small arrows nudge by one.

05 Move between galleries

Every photo carries a “Move to...” control — send it from Home to Project 07 in one click. Retitle any project inline.

06 That’s it — it saves itself

Every change writes itself and is live worldwide within about a minute. There is no publish button to forget.

GOLDEN RULE

Always add photos through the admin — never into cloud storage directly. The admin is what tells the website the photo exists. Files dropped into storage alone would sit there unseen.

Shoot huge. The stack handles the rest.

Camera originals of any size — including 35 MB, 6000×9000 medium-format files — are exactly what this was built around. Nothing about your workflow needs to shrink.

WHAT HAPPENS TO EACH FILE

IN your original, any resolution

RESIZE longest edge → 3840 px (4K)

ENCODE WebP, quality 85 — visually lossless

GUARD if still large, quality steps down until it fits

OUT ≈ 1.5–3.5 MB, ready for the world

Sharp on a phone, exact on a 4K monitor. Conversion happens in your browser the moment you drop the file — originals never leave your computer.

PRACTICAL NOTES

ONE HUNDRED PHOTOS select all, drop once — they queue in order

ORIENTATION vertical 4:5 reads best fullscreen

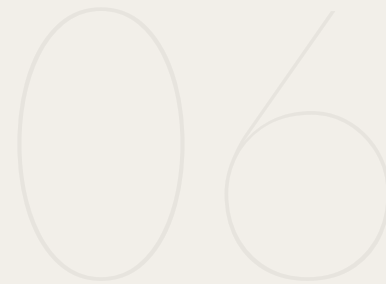
KEEP ORIGINALS the stored WebPs are masters, not backups

HUGE BATCHES a desktop script converts a folder offline first

REPLACING drop a new file onto any slot — old slot only

BEFORE YOU UPLOAD

Pick your final selects. The slideshow is a curated book, not an archive — twenty remarkable images hold attention better than two hundred good ones. Keep the archive in your own storage; put the statement online.



A ten-minute checklist before you share the link.

Most of this is done once, by whoever sets the site up for you. Keep this page for the day you take the keys.

01

Lock the admin

Remove “open access” testing mode so the password is required again. Two clicks in the hosting dashboard and one redeploy.

02

Connect your domain

yourname.com and admin.yourname.com, verified in the hosting dashboard. HTTPS is automatic.

03

Make it yours

Real Instagram handle, real email, agency names and regions, your story and measurements. Each is one short text edit.

04

The single-photo test

Drop one photo into the home slideshow. Within a minute it should appear on the live site — that proves the whole pipeline end to end.

05

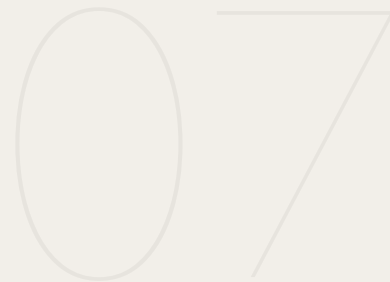
The zero-bytes test

Open the site with the browser’s developer tools → Network tab. Reload and click through: every photograph’s address should show your Cloudflare domain — never the hosting one. If any photo loads from the host, something is proxying and the free plan is bleeding.

06

Phone check

Swipe the slideshow, open every gallery, tap every menu. The site is fully responsive — confirm it feels like you.



What happens if the internet falls in love with you.

A press feature, a viral campaign, a million visits in a week — the stack absorbs far more than you'll realistically hit. Here is the honest ceiling map.

THE FIRST CEILING

Vercel's 100 GB — at roughly 1.6M monthly visitors. The dashboard shows usage; you'd see it coming weeks out.

PHOTOS

effectively uncapped — Cloudflare doesn't meter their bandwidth at all

STORAGE

10 GB $\approx$ 3,000 photos; years of galleries

IF YOU HIT IT

the host pauses the site until the month resets — it emails you first; nothing is lost

THE FIX, WHEN NEEDED

one paid plan (~\$20/mo) multiplies the ceiling ~10x; everything else stays free

IF THE SITE CHANGES HANDS

Everything transfers cleanly: the code lives in a git repository, the photos in your own cloud bucket, and both platforms invite the new owner via email. An afternoon, with zero downtime.

IF YOU WANT CHANGES

Typography, palette, page structure, number of galleries — the codebase is small, commented, and built on the most common tools in the industry. Any competent developer can run with it.

THE PROMISE

Between here and a million visitors a month, the budget does not move. You will outgrow agencies, cameras and calendars long before you outgrow this bill.



Make it yours.

The complete stack — code, admin, deployment runbook, and an AI-agent skill that rebuilds the whole system from a single instruction — is open source under the MIT license. Copy it, restyle it, hand it to your developer, or let an AI assistant walk you through setup using the included skill.

FRONTEND	Vite + React + TypeScript, editorial design system
HOSTING	Vercel free tier
PHOTOGRAPHS	Cloudflare R2, edge-cached, free egress
CONTENT SYSTEM	drag-and-drop admin, manifest-driven, no database
TYPEFACE	Jost — open Futura revival
LICENSE	MIT — yours, permanently